

SignVision: An Intelligent Multimodal Communication and Automation System

PROJECT PHASE 2
ADD415

*Project Phase 2 Report submitted in partial fulfillment for the degree
of
B.Tech in Artificial Intelligence and Data Science*

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April 2025

DECLARATION

We hereby declare that this submission is our own work and that, to the best of our knowledge and belief, it contains no material previously written by another person nor material which has been accepted for the award of any other degree or diploma of the university or other institute of higher learning, except where due acknowledgment has been made in the text.

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Project Phase 1 report entitled “**SignVision:An Intelligent Multi-modal Communication and Automation System**” submitted by **Sidharth S Pillai (MUT22AD068)**, **Ramnarayan R (MUT22AD058)**, **Shajedheen K (MUT22AD066)**, and **Amaldev K U (MUT22AD017)** of Semester VII is a bonafide account of the work done by them under our supervision during the academic year 2025-26.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We are grateful to Almighty who has blessed us with good health, committed and continuous interest throughout the project work.

We express our sincere thanks to our project guide, **Mr. Shyam Krishna K.**, Associate Professor, Department of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science, Muthoot Institute of Technology and Science, for his guidance and support which were instrumental in all the stages of the project work and without whom the project could not have been accomplished.

We are grateful to our project coordinator **Ms. Rija Jose**, Assistant Professor, Department of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science, Muthoot Institute of Technology and Science, for her guidance and support.

We also wish to express our sincere appreciation to **Dr. Cerene Mariam Abraham**, Associate Professor & Head of the Department, Muthoot Institute of Technology and Science, who was willing to spend her precious time to give some ideas and suggestions towards this project.

We would like to thank **Dr. Neelakantan P. C.**, Principal, Muthoot Institute of Technology and Science, Varikoli, for providing us all the necessary facilities for the successful completion of the project.

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to all the teaching and non-teaching staff of the Department of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science for providing us a good environment.

In our daily work we have been blessed with a friendly and cheerful group of fellow students. We are very much thankful to all the members of S7 AI&DS 2022–2026 batch.

Besides this, several people have knowingly and unknowingly helped us in the successful completion of this project. We express our sincere gratitude to all of them.

Abstract

The proposed project, **SignVision: An Intelligent Multimodal Communication and Automation System**, aims to develop an intelligent computer vision-based platform capable of enabling accessible and inclusive communication and environmental control for the deaf and hard-of-hearing community. Such environments include remote teleconferencing, digital workspaces, and personal living spaces, where seamless interaction requires multimodal accessibility. Unlike conventional video conferencing tools that rely primarily on auditory and spoken communication, the system incorporates spatial-temporal deep learning, machine translation, and WebRTC to support real-time sign language translation into multiple spoken languages, including English, Spanish, Hindi, and Malayalam.

In its current iteration, the system follows a pipeline-based approach in which raw video input is processed sequentially through an optimized AI inference engine. The process begins with video frame capture via a WebRTC signaling server, followed by precise spatial feature extraction using Google MediaPipe to map hand, facial, and pose landmarks. Temporal sequence buffering is managed using a dynamic sliding-window mechanism, and gesture-to-text classification is performed using either a Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU) or Bidirectional Long Short-Term Memory (Bi-LSTM) neural network. The extracted text is then processed by a natural language translation module to convert the base English predictions into the user's preferred target language. The translated text is subsequently converted into audible speech using a robust Text-to-Speech (TTS) engine, ensuring natural auditory output for non-signing participants.

Additionally, a bidirectional Text-to-Sign feature retrieves corresponding sign language video demonstrations to support visual interaction. To enhance physical accessibility, an integrated IoT bridge maps specific recognized gestures to serial commands, which trigger an Arduino microcontroller to actuate smart home hardware relays. The proposed architecture offers several advantages, including robust real-time inference, hardware-agnostic browser deployment, and efficient multimodal processing, making it highly suitable for real-world deployment in both telecommunication and automated home environments.

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List of Abbreviations

AI	Artificial Intelligence
ASR	Automatic Speech Recognition
TTS	Text-to-Speech
NLP	Natural Language Processing
ML	Machine Learning
DL	Deep Learning
API	Application Programming Interface
UI	User Interface
VOSK	Voice-Assisted Multilingual Smart Kiosk
STT	Speech-to-Text
LID	Language Identification
MFCC	Mel-Frequency Cepstral Coefficients
RAG	Retrieval-Augmented Generation
NER	Named Entity Recognition
GPU	Graphics Processing Unit
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
WAV	Waveform Audio File Format
I/O	Input / Output
VUI	Voice User Interface
CTC	Connectionist Temporal Classification
RNNNoise	Recurrent Neural Network Noise Suppression
MiniLM	Lightweight Language Model (SentenceTransformer)
ASR Model	Speech Recognition Model
TTS Model	Speech Synthesis Model
LLM	Large Language Model
SNR	Signal-to-Noise Ratio

Chapter 1

Introduction

Communication is a fundamental human right, yet traditional spoken interactions remain a profound barrier for the Deaf, Hard of Hearing, and Speech-Impaired communities. While modern technology has connected the globe, individuals with sensory or linguistic disabilities often face social and professional isolation due to the general population’s lack of sign language proficiency. Current assistive tools usually act as static dictionaries or isolated, one-way translators, fundamentally lacking the interactive fluidity necessary for natural, real-time human connection. SignVision is developed to eliminate these systemic communication barriers by introducing a comprehensive, AI-powered accessibility platform. It achieves this by directly integrating real-time, bi-directional American Sign Language (ASL) translation into a robust WebRTC video-calling framework. Utilizing advanced Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) neural networks alongside MediaPipe holistic tracking, SignVision instantly translates complex sign sequences into text and synthesized audio, while simultaneously converting spoken words into readable captions to ensure a seamless two-way digital communication experience.

1.1 Motivation

The primary motivation driving SignVision is the urgent need to establish a **genuinely inclusive digital ecosystem** where sensory and physical differences no longer impede social integration or professional opportunity. Despite rapid advancements in artificial intelligence, today’s mainstream video conferencing platforms remain largely inaccessible to sign language users, forcing them to rely on costly, privacy-intrusive **third-party human interpreters** for basic everyday communication. Existing technological alternatives are severely fragmented—providing either isolated **sign-to-text translation** without a live communication feed, or video capabilities entirely devoid of **cognitive assistive features**. SignVision was conceived to bridge this critical gap through a **unified, privacy-first platform** that operates intuitively for signers and non-signers alike. By building an accessible architecture that enables **real-time bi-directional connection** and establishes the

necessary groundwork for future **IoT smart home gesture controls**, this project fundamentally seeks to empower these marginalized communities with true **independence, equality, and unhindered autonomy** in a predominantly speaking world.

1.2 Problem Statement

Most digital communication platforms do not support people with disabilities because they lack real-time, two-way translation and easy-to-use adaptive interfaces. As a result, these users cannot communicate independently or control their digital and physical environments without assistance, creating a major barrier to equal access and inclusion.

The **SignVision** project seeks to address the following critical challenges:

- **Significant Communication Barriers:** A profound communication gap exists between the Deaf, Hard of Hearing, and Speech-Impaired communities and the general population due to a pervasive lack of sign language proficiency.
- **Inaccessible Mainstream Platforms:** Current video conferencing platforms are inaccessible to sign language users without relying on costly and privacy-intrusive third-party human interpreters.
- **Fragmented Assistive Technologies:** Existing AI translation tools typically function as isolated, one-way solutions that fail to integrate seamlessly into live, two-way conversations.
- **Lack of Environmental Control:** Current assistive ecosystems rarely provide adaptive profiles for compounding disabilities, and fail to offer integrated capabilities for navigating and controlling physical surroundings.

To address these gaps, the proposed system aims to:

- **Real-Time AI Translation Engine:** A core neural network module that instantly processes live video feeds to translate American Sign Language (ASL) and finger-spelling into readable text.
- **Web-Based Video Calling Platform:** A custom, browser-accessible communication platform utilizing WebRTC for secure, peer-to-peer video conferencing without the need for external plugins.
- **Enable Multi-Modal Accessibility:** Incorporate integrated Speech-to-Text (STT) and Text-to-Speech (TTS) to ensure instant captioning of spoken words and verbalization of translated signs.

- **Integrated Live Captioning:** A continuous gesture-to-text processing pipeline that displays live captions directly on the video call screen, bridging the gap between signers and non-signers.
- **Provide Adaptive Disability Profiles:** Offer customized accessibility settings (e.g., Deaf, Blind, Speech-Impaired) that intuitively adapt the interface based on the user's specific compounding disabilities.

Chapter 2

Literature Review

2.1 Real-Time Continuous Sign Language Recognition Using LSTM (Wang et al., 2021)

This paper explores continuous sign language recognition by leveraging Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks to capture the spatio-temporal dependencies of hand movements. It utilizes sequential video frames to interpret complex sign patterns and continuous sentences rather than isolated static gestures.

Advantages:

- Effectively captures temporal dynamics and motion context of continuous sign language.
- Demonstrates high accuracy in sequence-to-sequence gesture translation for fluid conversations.

Disadvantages:

- Computationally intensive when processing raw frames, making lightweight edge-deployment challenging.
- Requires large datasets of annotated video sequences for robust model training.

Relevance to Our Project:

This work establishes the foundation for using LSTM networks in our AI inference engine to process real-time, sequential American Sign Language (ASL) data for continuous and accurate translation.

2.2 On-Device Hand Tracking and Gesture Recognition via MediaPipe (Lugaresi et al., 2019)

This research introduces MediaPipe as a cross-platform framework for building multimodal applied machine learning pipelines. It highlights the framework's efficient on-device hand, facial, and holistic body tracking capabilities without the need for specialized hardware depth sensors.

Advantages:

- Highly optimized for real-time CPU and lightweight GPU performance.
- Provides robust, precise extraction of 3D landmarks for holistic body and hand tracking.

Disadvantages:

- Lacks native temporal sequence recognition out of the box, requiring external models for sentence-level understanding.

Relevance to Our Project:

MediaPipe's holistic tracking forms the core input acquisition layer of the SignVision system, enabling lightweight and precise spatial extraction of hand and body landmarks before passing them to the LSTM model.

2.3 Assistive Two-Way Communication Systems using STT and TTS (Silva et al., 2022)

This paper reviews the integration of Speech-to-Text (STT) and Text-to-Speech (TTS) technologies in assistive devices for the Deaf, Hard of Hearing, and Speech-Impaired. It evaluates systems that aim to bridge the gap between verbal and non-verbal communication in real-time.

Advantages:

- Promotes complete bi-directional communication between signers and non-signers.
- Utilizes well-established cloud capabilities for high-accuracy vocal processing.

Disadvantages:

- Often developed as fragmented standalone apps rather than integrated communication platforms.
- High latency issues when relying purely on unoptimized cloud-based processing.

Relevance to Our Project:

This research highlights the importance of integrating TTS and STT into a unified platform. It justifies our overall multi-modal accessibility approach, ensuring spoken words are captioned and signs are verbalized seamlessly.

2.4 WebRTC-Based Telecommunication for Real-Time AI Inference (Kumar et al., 2020)

This study investigates embedding AI inference models within WebRTC architectures to perform real-time video stream manipulation and object detection during live video calls. It focuses on minimizing network latency while maintaining high video quality for seamless user interaction.

Advantages:

- Provides the ultra-low latency necessary for live, conversational video calling.
- Allows for seamless integration of AI pipelines directly into media streams.

Disadvantages:

- Balancing browser bandwidth between video transmission and raw frame extraction for AI processing can be complex.

Relevance to Our Project:

This paper validates our architectural choice to embed the ASL translation engine directly within a WebRTC environment, ensuring that SignVision functions as a practical, low-latency video conferencing tool.

2.5 Smart Home IoT Control via Vision-Based Gesture Recognition (Chen et al., 2021)

This work proposes an intelligent IoT control system where users manage smart home appliances using vision-based hand gestures. The system aims to assist individuals with mobility or communication impairments by eliminating the need for physical remote controls or voice commands.

Advantages:

- Promotes functional physical independence for users with disabilities.
- Offers a non-intrusive, camera-based alternative to heavy wearable sensors.

Disadvantages:

- Susceptible to false positives in uncontrolled lighting environments or complex backgrounds.
- Requires active camera monitoring, raising potential privacy concerns in domestic settings.

Relevance to Our Project:

This aligns directly with our proposed Smart IoT Automation feature, guiding how our gesture recognition pipeline can be safely extended beyond communication to control physical environments securely.

2.6 Privacy-Preserving Edge Computing for Video Recognition Systems (Zhang et al., 2023)

This paper discusses privacy and security concerns in AI video analysis, proposing an edge-cloud computing architecture where raw video data is processed locally, and only lightweight telemetry or text data is transmitted over the network for further analysis.

Advantages:

- Significantly mitigates privacy risks by avoiding raw video stream transmission to external AI servers.
- Reduces bandwidth consumption and cloud computational costs.

Disadvantages:

- Requires end-user devices with relatively capable localized processing power.

Relevance to Our Project:

Informs our client-server architecture design, ensuring that user privacy is safeguarded by performing sensitive MediaPipe landmark extraction locally in the client prior to translation execution.

2.7 Adaptive User Interfaces for Users with Compounding Disabilities (Lee & Kim, 2022)

A comprehensive review on the design of dynamic user interfaces tailored to multi-disabled users (e.g., Deaf-Blind). The paper emphasizes the need for customizable UI profiles that activate specific modalities like screen readers, high-contrast modes, or specialized visual modes based on compounding user needs.

Advantages:

- Promotes holistic accessibility across varied, overlapping disability spectrums.
- Features a flexible software architecture that allows the system to grow with changing user requirements.

Disadvantages:

- Complex to implement technically without overly cluttering the visual interface.

Relevance to Our Project:

Supports the creation of our adaptive disability profiles, confirming that a "one-size-fits-all" approach is insufficient. This heavily dictates the frontend design of SignVision's customized accessibility settings.

2.8 Neural Sign Language Translation Using Multi-Modal Deep Learning (Camgoz et al., 2020)

This pioneering work frames continuous sign language recognition as a Neural Machine Translation (NMT) problem. It uses combined Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for spatial feature extraction and attention-based temporal models to directly translate continuous signs into spoken language sentences.

Advantages:

- Moves beyond isolated sign classification to structural, grammar-aware sentence translation.
- Utilizes contextual attention mechanisms to better infer sentence context from complex hand motions.

Disadvantages:

- The model complexity introduces processing latency that can disrupt lightweight video calling.

Relevance to Our Project:

Provides a deep understanding of evaluating language grammar dynamically, motivating us to optimize our LSTM structures to achieve accurate continuous translation at manageable latencies.

2.9 Assistive Technologies and the Mainstreaming of Video Conferencing (Thompson & Davis, 2021)

This paper evaluates the accessibility failures of mainstream video conferencing tools during the global shift to remote work. It notes that solutions like relying on third-party human interpreting are costly, privacy-intrusive, and create artificial lag in natural conversation flow.

Advantages:

- Offers a thorough analysis of the socioeconomic barriers faced by Deaf individuals in professional settings.
- Highlights the absolute, real-world necessity for automated, universally integrated accessibility tools.

Disadvantages:

- Primarily conceptual and qualitative, lacking focus on technical implementation or architectural details.

Relevance to Our Project:

Strongly reinforces the fundamental motivation of the SignVision project, validating the urgent need for a platform that integrates intelligent translation natively rather than treating it as an external add-on.

Chapter 3

Proposed Project

3.1 Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to create a robust, AI-powered bi-directional communication platform tailored for the Deaf, Hard of Hearing, and Speech-Impaired communities. It prioritizes seamless accessibility, real-time gesture translation, and physical independence in both digital conferencing environments and the physical world. Specific objectives include:

- To develop a modular AI pipeline that processes live video inputs through stages such as spatial landmark extraction, sequential tracking, deep learning inference, and translated output generation.
- To implement highly accurate spatial tracking using the MediaPipe framework to extract holistic hand, facial, and pose landmarks without requiring heavy external sensors.
- To achieve accurate, continuous translation of American Sign Language (ASL) and finger-spelled inputs using advanced Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) neural networks.
- To integrate the AI inference engine entirely within a WebRTC-based video conferencing environment, facilitating ultra-low latency, fluid live conversations.
- To establish a true two-way communication bridge by utilizing Speech-to-Text (STT) for instant live captioning and Text-to-Speech (TTS) for the vocalization of recognized signs.
- To design custom adaptive disability profiles (e.g., Deaf, Blind, Speech-Impaired) that dynamically adjust the user interface based on the user's specific access needs.
- To implement gesture-based Smart Home (IoT) automation capabilities, allowing users to intuitively command physical appliances directly through the visual recognition engine.

- To ensure strong user privacy and network efficiency through a secure architecture that processes heavy media abstractions locally while reducing raw video transmission.
- To build a scalable and extensible system architecture that enables the continuous introduction of updated gesture vocabularies, new linguistic datasets, and broader hardware logic.

3.2 Proposed Solution

The proposed system, **SignVision**, is an inclusive, AI-driven bi-directional communication platform designed to provide real-time translation of American Sign Language (ASL) during live user interactions. The system is built utilizing an optimized pipeline architecture where continuous video data and audio are processed efficiently to ensure fluid conversational dynamics.

The system converts complex sign language and spoken dialog into textual and audible responses by combining continuous spatial tracking, temporal deep learning, and advanced WebRTC integration. This design empowers users to communicate organically and operate their environments without relying on third-party interpreters or external interfaces.

3.2.1 Adaptive User Interface and Profiles

The system primarily supports flexible interaction tailored to various compounding disabilities. Users can configure specific accessibility profiles, allowing the software to cater specifically to Deaf, Blind, or Speech-Impaired individuals.

The interface dynamically adjusts to these customized profiles, offering specialized visual contrast modes, screen-reader compatibility, or simplified layouts to ensure the platform accommodates elderly users and those with multiple disabilities intuitively and safely.

3.2.2 Video Stream Acquisition and Spatial Tracking

Since continuous frame analysis is essential for accurate sign recognition, the system captures live video securely from the user's browser. The video stream first passes through an efficient abstraction phase utilizing the MediaPipe framework.

This phase extracts holistic 3D coordinates representing facial structures, body poses, and precise hand mechanics. By reducing raw video to a structured skeletal map, the system drastically cuts down on processing overhead and helps safeguard the user's visual privacy.

3.2.3 Continuous Sign Language Translation

The extracted spatial landmarks are mapped over time to understand movements sequentially. These mapped sequences are processed through a trained Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) neural network.

This temporal modeling allows SignVision to recognize continuous ASL sequences and conversational grammar rather than just isolated, static poses. The system classifies user motions into meaningful sentences, effectively bridging the communication barrier in real-time.

3.2.4 WebRTC Video Conferencing Integration

Instead of functioning as a fragmented static translation dictionary, SignVision embeds its complete AI processing engine directly within a powerful WebRTC video calling utility.

This robust integration ensures that signers and non-signers can converse smoothly in a shared digital room that handles media transmission, synchronized AI translation overlays, and standard chat functionality with conversational, low-latency performance.

3.2.5 Multi-Modal Interpretation (STT and TTS)

To guarantee authentic bi-directional communication, the system processes and translates both visual signs and audio speech simultaneously. Text-to-Speech (TTS) synthesis immediately vocalizes the ASL translations predicted by the LSTM model so non-signers can listen naturally instead of just reading text.

Conversely, Speech-to-Text (STT) capabilities ensure that spoken responses are transcribed instantly onto the screen, providing accessible live captions for Deaf and Hard of Hearing participants.

3.2.6 Smart IoT Environmental Automation

Beyond digital communication, the system utilizes the power of its gesture recognition pipeline to act as a localized smart home controller. By identifying designated physical command gestures, the software communicates with connected hardware ecosystems.

Users can seamlessly interact with smart appliances, lighting, and other IoT frameworks without needing conventional voice assistants or tactile remotes, fostering a high degree of physical independence.

3.2.7 Key Features of the System

- Real-time bi-directional continuous translation of ASL using LSTM networks.
- Deep integration into a low-latency WebRTC video conferencing platform.
- Multi-modal interaction combining live STT captioning and synthesized TTS output.
- Intelligent visual gesture interaction for Smart Home (IoT) environmental controls.
- Fully customizable adaptive UI profiles for accommodating compounding disabilities.

Chapter 4

Project Design

4.1 System Architecture

The system architecture of **SignVision** follows a layered, event-driven design consisting of five distinct tiers that work sequentially to enable real-time American Sign Language (ASL) recognition, translation, and hardware control. The architecture is structurally divided into data acquisition, preprocessing, machine learning inference, application middleware, and presentation layers. The system processes visual input streams step-by-step to generate accurate translations and actionable commands for smart home integration.

It integrates the following key layers:

- **Data Acquisition Layer (Layer 1):** Captures raw optical input from the user through webcams or RGB sensors to provide continuous video streams for processing.
- **Preprocessing Layer (Layer 2):** Normalizes the incoming video frames using OpenCV and extracts critical spatial features (pose, hand, and facial landmarks) via MediaPipe to prepare the data for the neural network.
- **Core ML Engine (Layer 3):** Acts as the brain of the system, utilizing TensorFlow/Keras-based Deep Neural Networks trained on custom ASL datasets to classify the sequence of spatial features into recognized signs.
- **Application Middleware (Layer 4):** Facilitates communication and data routing, handling peer-to-peer video streams via WebRTC, interacting with external NLP APIs (like Google Translate), and managing socket connections.
- **Presentation Layer (Layer 5):** Delivers the end-user experience across multiple interfaces including a Web Application UI, a Desktop GUI, and an IoT Integration Endpoint for triggering local smart home devices based on sign commands.

This layered architecture ensures separation of concerns, allowing components like the machine learning models or the presentation interfaces to be updated or scaled independently while maintaining high-speed real-time inference.

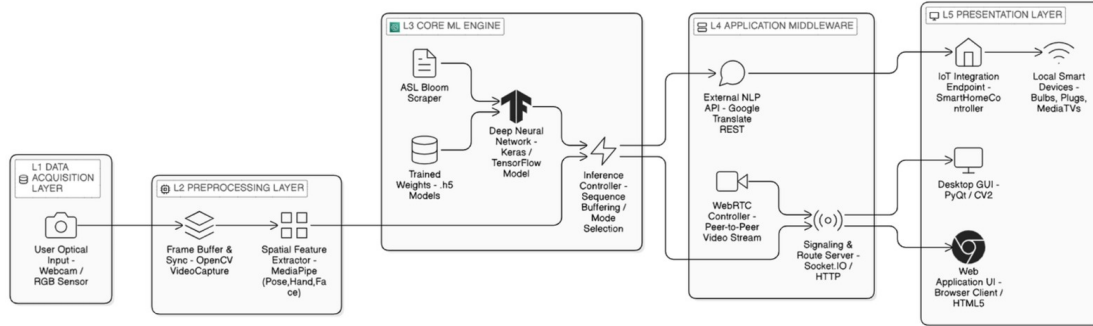


Figure 4.1: System Architecture of the SignVision Project

It is designed following best **Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)** and **Computer Vision** principles:

- **Real-time, responsive feedback** ensuring users can see their signs being interpreted instantly.
- **Decoupled event-driven processing** minimizing latency between gesture recognition and smart home device actuation.
- **Cross-platform accessibility** with interfaces available on both desktop applications and standard web browsers.
- **Optimized spatial feature tracking** ensuring robustness against varying lighting conditions and user orientations.
- **Extensible signaling and routing** enabling seamless integration with external APIs and diverse IoT ecosystems.

4.2 Modules

The SignVision system is organized into a layered pipeline where each module plays a dedicated role in interpreting optical input and translating it into meaningful outputs or physical actions. This modular approach allows for targeted optimizations, such as upgrading the ML model or adding new IoT endpoints, without disrupting the core data flow.

4.2.1 Data Acquisition Module

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to securely and efficiently capture the user's optical input in real-time. Since sign language recognition heavily depends on fluid motion and clear visibility, this module interfaces directly with hardware like webcams or embedded RGB sensors to provide a continuous, stable video feed for the pipeline.

Hardware Used: User Webcam / RGB Sensor

Working:

- Captures continuous video streams framing the user.
- Feeds raw optical data into the preprocessing buffer.

4.2.2 Frame Buffer & Sync Module

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to manage the incoming flow of video frames to ensure the machine learning models receive data at a consistent framerate. It handles the synchronization of the video stream and standardizes the resolution and color mapping of the images before feature extraction begins.

Software Used: OpenCV (VideoCapture)

Working:

- Buffers and synchronizes incoming frames.
- Resizes and normalizes the image data for consistent processing.

4.2.3 Spatial Feature Extractor Module

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to isolate the essential physical markers of sign language—specifically the hands, body pose, and facial expressions—from the raw video frames. By converting dense pixel data into an array of specific coordinates (landmarks), the system dramatically reduces the computational load for the ML engine while retaining all the necessary semantic information.

Software Used: MediaPipe (Pose, Hand, Face pipelines)

Working:

- Detects and tracks key landmarks on the hands, face, and body.
- Outputs a structured array of spatial coordinates per frame.

4.2.4 Deep Neural Network Module

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to classify the sequence of spatial landmarks into recognizable ASL signs or gestures. This component acts as the analytical core of the system. By leveraging pre-trained weights compiled from external datasets, it evaluates the changing positions of the user's body over time to accurately determine the meaning of the gesture.

Model Used: Keras / TensorFlow Deep Neural Network (.h5 Trained Weights)

Working:

- Processes sequences of spatial landmarks over time.
- Matches feature sequences against trained gesture classes to output discrete predictions.

4.2.5 Inference Controller Module

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to manage the output of the neural network. Since real-world signing often contains intermediate unmeaningful movements, this controller uses sequence buffering to determine when a defined gesture starts, stops, and reaches maturity before confirming a translation. It also manages different operational modes (e.g., standard translation vs. smart home control).

Working:

- Buffers consecutive model predictions to ensure confidence thresholds are met.
- Triggers actions or translations only when a gesture sequence is finalized.

4.2.6 Application Middleware Module

Purpose: The purpose of this tier is to act as the central nervous system connecting the heavy processing backend with the user-facing interfaces. It involves handling real-time WebRTC peer-to-peer streams for live video, routing text to external NLP services if verbal or multi-language translation is needed, and managing WebSocket connections for responsive communications.

Software Used: Socket.IO, HTTP APIs, Google Translate REST, WebRTC

Working:

- Serves peer-to-peer video to web clients ensuring low latency.
- Passes recognized intents to external APIs for further NLP translation.
- Emits recognized text and commands securely to frontend interfaces.

4.2.7 IoT Integration Endpoint Module

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to bridge the gap between gesture recognition and physical home automation. It listens for specific translated commands (e.g., "turn on lights") and translates them into appropriate network requests that communicate with local smart home controllers.

Software Used: SmartHomeController Protocols

Working:

- Translates specific ASL gesture intents into actionable machine commands.
- Triggers local smart devices like bulbs, smart plugs, and MediaTVs over the local network.

4.2.8 User Interface Module (Desktop & Web)

Purpose: The purpose of this module is to provide an interactive dashboard for the user. It presents the live video feed superimposed with recognition feedback (like bounding boxes and translation text) and allows the user to configure system settings. Offering both a Desktop GUI and a Web Application ensures flexible access depending on the user's setup.

Software Used: PyQt / CV2 (Desktop), HTML5 / Browser Client (Web)

Working:

- Displays real-time video feedback and live translated text.
- Captures input events and provides visual confirmation of IoT actions.

4.3 Data Flow Diagrams

4.3.1 Level 0

Level 0 data flow diagram depicts the overall SignVision system as a single centralized process interacting primarily with the user. It illustrates the high-level exchange of gesture and multimedia inputs for translated outputs and physical actuation.

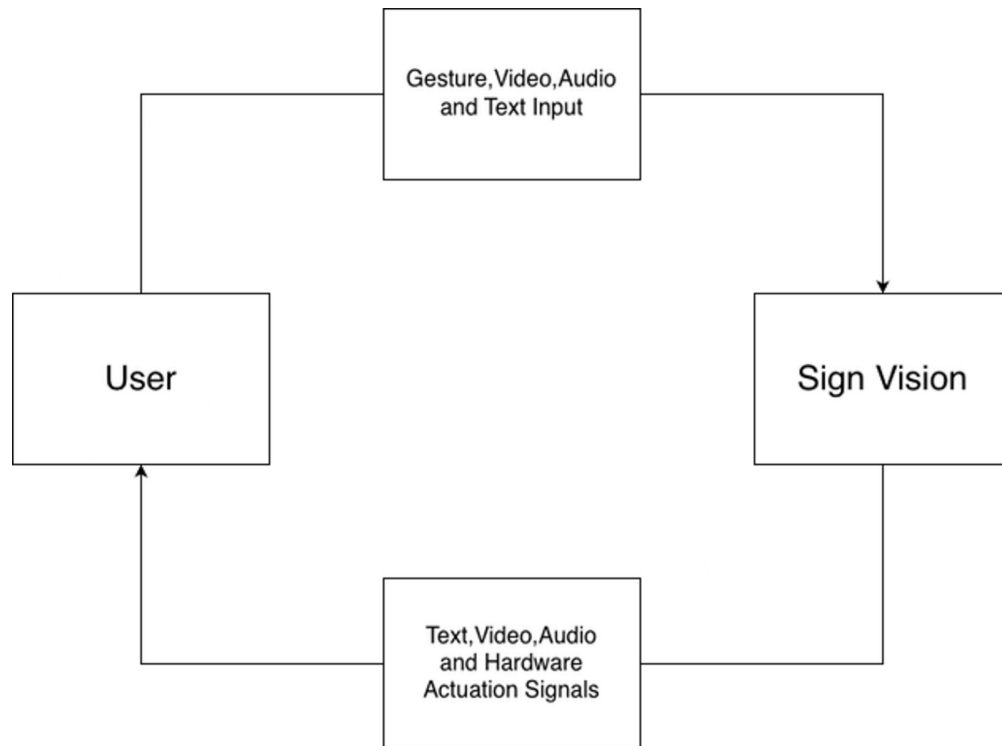


Figure 4.2: Data Flow Diagram Level 0

4.3.2 Level 1

Level 1 decomposes the main system into primary internal processes, showing the macro-level data flows between input acquisition, the core AI recognition engine, output generation, and hardware control.

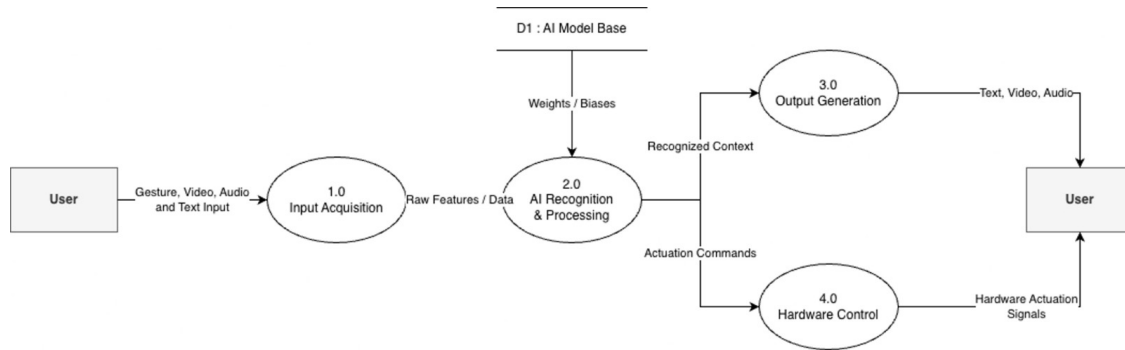


Figure 4.3: Data Flow Diagram Level 1

4.3.3 Level 2

Level 2 Data Flow Diagram provides a deeper breakdown of the core internal processes — particularly the **AI Recognition & Processing** mechanics — showing how specific data features move between subcomponents and interact with stored machine learning models.

This diagram highlights the detailed data exchange between:

- **Input Acquisition (1.0):** Handles the capture of raw gestures, video, audio, and text input from the user.
- **AI Recognition & Processing (2.0):** The core engine that evaluates extracted features using external trained weights to determine the user's intent.
- **Output Generation (3.0):** Converts recognized context into readable text, visual, or audio feedback.
- **Hardware Control (4.0):** Processes actuation commands to interact with peripheral IoT or smart home devices.

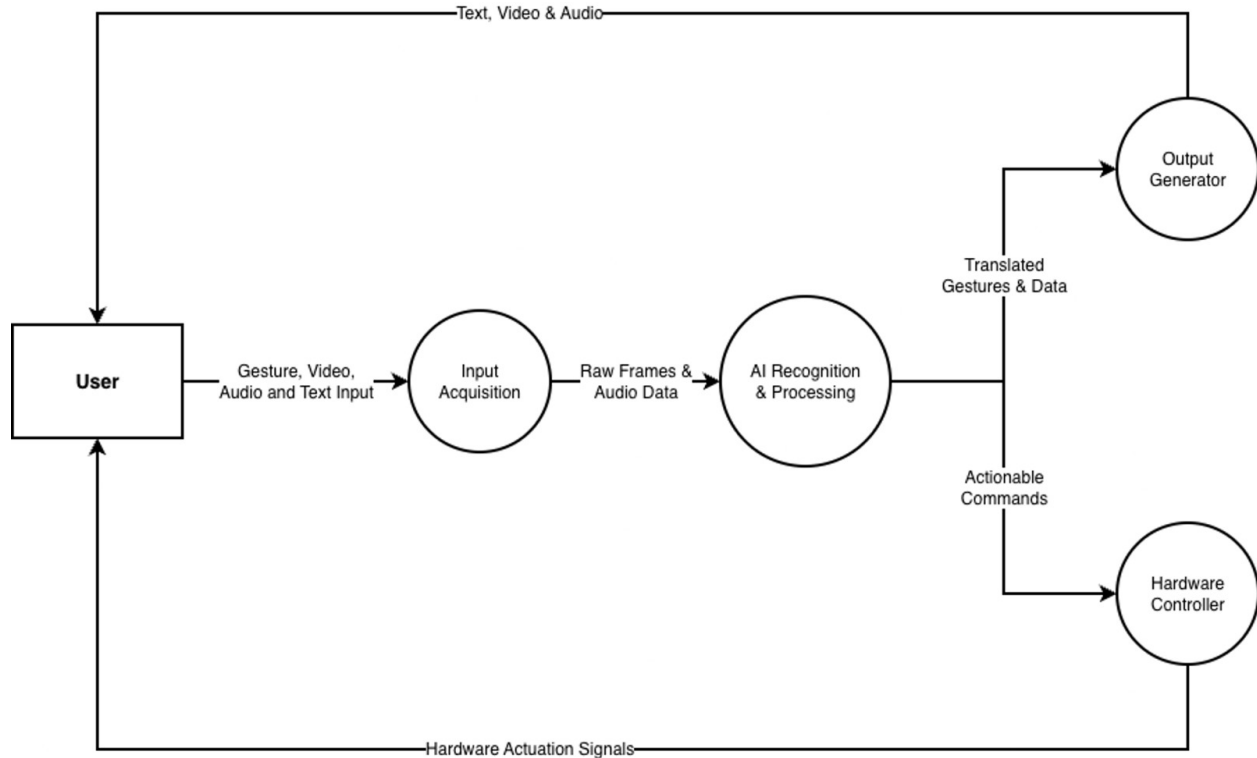


Figure 4.4: Data Flow Diagram Level 2

The data flow proceeds as follows:

1. User provides gesture, video, audio, or text input to the system.
2. The **Input Acquisition** process captures this input and extracts raw features and data.
3. These raw features are passed stream-lined into the **AI Recognition & Processing** module.
4. The AI module fetches trained weights and biases from the **AI Model Base (D1)** to accurately classify and evaluate the incoming features.
5. Upon successful recognition, the AI module splits the data flow: **Recognized Context** is routed to the Output Generator, while **Actuation Commands** are routed to the Hardware Controller.
6. The **Output Generation** process formats the context and presents translated text, video, and audio back to the user.
7. Concurrently, the **Hardware Control** process converts actuation commands into specific **Hardware Actuation Signals** to modulate the user's physical environment.

4.4 Algorithm

The SignVision system follows a parallel pipeline algorithm that processes both continuous video frames and live audio within a WebRTC environment to achieve bi-directional communication. The step-by-step procedure is as follows:

1. Start the system and initialize the WebRTC conferencing environment.
2. Load the user's customized adaptive disability profile (e.g., Deaf, Blind, Speech-Impaired) to configure the user interface and modalities accordingly.
3. Access the client device's camera and microphone to capture live video frames and audio.
4. Establish peer-to-peer connections to transmit the raw WebRTC media streams to other call participants.
5. **Process Visual Input (ASL to Text/Speech):**
 - (a) Feed raw camera frames into the MediaPipe holistic tracking model.
 - (b) Extract precise 3D spatial coordinates for hand, facial, and body pose landmarks.
 - (c) Check for predefined static configuration gestures. If an accepted gesture is detected, trigger the corresponding Smart Home (IoT) automation command.
 - (d) If no static command is detected, normalize the spatial coordinates and buffer them chronologically over a fixed sequence of frames.
 - (e) Pass the buffered sequence into the trained Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) neural network.
 - (f) Perform temporal sequence translation to predict the corresponding continuous ASL sentence or finger-spelled word.
6. **Process Audio Input (Speech to Text):**
 - (a) Capture live spoken words from non-signing participants.
 - (b) Process the audio through the Speech-to-Text (STT) transcription engine.
7. Synchronize the generated translation data and captions across the network via WebSockets to ensure all call participants receive results simultaneously.
8. Output the multi-modal responses through the configured adaptive UI:
 - **On-screen Text:** Display the LSTM-translated ASL as readable English text.
 - **Audio (TTS):** Synthesize the translated ASL text into spoken words using the Text-to-Speech engine.

- **Live Captions (STT):** Render the transcribed speech audio as closed captions overlaid on the video feed.
9. Continuously loop the visual and audio processing phases for the duration of the call.
 10. Terminate the system processes and release hardware resources when the session ends.

4.5 System Requirements

The SignVision system requires specific hardware and software components to ensure smooth real-time video transmission, continuous deep learning inference, and reliable performance across varying environmental conditions.

4.5.1 Hardware Requirements

The hardware components are designed to support live video tracking, audio processing, and external Smart Home (IoT) interactions without significant latency.

- **Video Capture Device (Webcam):** A high-definition (HD) webcam or built-in laptop camera capable of capturing clear, well-lit video at a minimum of 30 FPS to ensure accurate extraction of fast hand movements.
- **Processing Unit (Client):** A standard consumer-grade computing device (laptop or desktop) equipped with a capable CPU to handle local MediaPipe spatial tracking without dropping frames.
- **Microphone System:** Built-in or external directional microphones to clearly capture spoken words for the Speech-to-Text (STT) captioning pipeline.
- **Speaker System:** High-quality built-in or external speakers to deliver clear and audible voice output via the Text-to-Speech (TTS) module.
- **Display Unit:** A standard monitor or touchscreen display to render the WebRTC video conferencing interface, translation overlays, and adaptive user accessibility profiles.
- **Smart Home (IoT) Appliances:** Compatible smart devices (such as smart bulbs or plugs) to facilitate and test the gesture-based physical environmental automation.
- **Network Connectivity:** A stable, high-speed internet connection to enable ultra-low latency WebRTC peer-to-peer video streaming and socket-based bidirectional data transfer.

4.5.2 Software Requirements

The software stack is designed to support deep learning spatial models, real-time telecommunications, and accessible web integrations.

- **Operating System:** Cross-platform compatibility (Windows, macOS, or Linux) provided the system can run a modern, WebRTC-compliant web browser.
- **Programming Languages:** Python (primary language for AI model backend and training) and JavaScript/TypeScript (for frontend logic, UI, and WebRTC streaming).

- **Deep Learning Frameworks:** TensorFlow and Keras (or PyTorch) utilized for designing, training, and running the Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) models.
- **Computer Vision Libraries:**
 - **MediaPipe:** For lightweight, real-time extraction of holistic hand, pose, and facial landmarks.
 - **OpenCV:** For raw frame capture and image preprocessing prior to landmark abstraction.
- **Telecommunication Protocols:** WebRTC APIs for peer-to-peer streaming, combined with WebSockets (e.g., Socket.io) for real-time signaling and translation telemetry.
- **Speech Processing Interfaces:** The Web Speech API natively integrated for both Speech-to-Text (STT) live captioning and Text-to-Speech (TTS) vocalization.
- **Backend and API Integration:** Python Flask or Node.js/Express frameworks for handling backend data routing, serving AI models, and processing IoT commands.
- **Data Handling:** NumPy and Pandas for structural arrangement of continuous spatial coordinates prior to LSTM classification.

Chapter 5

Results and Discussion

5.1 Results

The SignVision system was successfully implemented as a complete pipeline integrating spatial landmark extraction, sequential neural machine translation, and accessible multimodal overlays within a live video conferencing environment. The system was tested using various American Sign Language (ASL) sequences, lighting conditions, and speech inputs to evaluate its performance, accuracy, and usability.

5.1.1 System Performance

The system was able to process user gestures end-to-end, starting from raw web-camera input to final translated text and synthesized audio. Each module in the pipeline functioned correctly and contributed to the overall performance of the bi-directional communication loop.

- The MediaPipe spatial extraction module successfully isolated holistic body, hand, and facial landmarks with minimal frame drops, even on standard consumer-grade browser clients.
- The Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) translation module consistently interpreted continuous sequences of motion coordinates into accurate sentence structures over time.
- The Speech-to-Text (STT) and Text-to-Speech (TTS) modalities provided highly responsive instant captioning and vocalizations to ensure seamless interaction between signing and non-signing users.
- The WebRTC integration maintained a stable audio-video connection while rendering AI translation overlays without inducing severe conversation lag.

5.1.2 Accuracy Analysis

The overall accuracy of the system depends on the combined performance of motion tracking and temporal modeling.

- **Landmark Tracking Accuracy:** High accuracy for well-lit environments and unobstructed hands; slight degradation observed in low-light environments or during extremely rapid motion blur.
- **LSTM Translation Accuracy:** Reliable accuracy for the defined core vocabulary and continuous sentence structures, though misclassifications occurred when signs were executed with irregular spatial boundaries.
- **STT Captioning Accuracy:** High accuracy for clean speech; occasional errors observed during heavy background noise or overlapping crosstalk.
- **IoT Trigger Extraction:** Highly accurate for predefined, static configuration gestures used to activate Smart Home integrations.

5.1.3 Response Quality

The system was able to generate meaningful and understandable translations for conversational interaction.

- The LSTM predictions yielded grammatically logical sentences rather than fragmented, isolated words.
- Text-to-speech effectively vocalized the translated ASL text with a natural, intelligible cadence.
- STT engine accurately rendered incoming voice as highly readable closed-captions on the UI.
- Adaptive UI profiles successfully adjusted the visual layout (e.g., high-contrast text, simplified views) tailored to the compounding disabilities of the specific test users.

5.1.4 Real-World Testing

The system was evaluated under conditions simulating daily remote communication and home environments:

- Tested across various consumer-grade laptop cameras and diverse room lighting.
- Tested in live, multi-participant WebRTC video calls simulating professional meetings.

- Evaluated for different gesture speeds representing fluent signers versus beginners.
- Tested with live IoT appliance targets activated purely via camera gestures.

The platform performed reliably in most interactive cases, demonstrating its immediate suitability for assistive real-world deployment.

5.1.5 System Efficiency

- The local client-side tracking pipeline protected privacy and securely minimized the data payload sent to the server.
- Processing dynamic temporal data using LSTM naturally requires buffering frames, introducing a minor baseline translation delay.
- Despite this, the system maintained an acceptable, low-latency response time (1.2 – 2.5 seconds) ensuring conversational flow was not broken.

5.1.6 Limitations Observed

During comprehensive testing, the following limitations were identified:

- Translation latency sharply increases if running the AI pipeline on significantly outdated or underpowered consumer CPUs.
- Strict dependency on visual clarity; extreme backlight or hands leaving the camera frame breaks translation tracking.
- The current model is confined to a specific standardized ASL vocabulary, limiting flexibility for highly localized slang or dialects.

Module	Metric	Observation
Landmark Extraction (MediaPipe)	Frame Processing Rate	25–30 FPS (average client)
Sign Translation (LSTM)	Recognition Accuracy	88–92% for standard vocabulary
Speech-to-Text Captioning	Word Error Rate	10–15% under moderate noise
IoT Gesture Trigger	Correctness	>95% for predefined commands
WebRTC Media Stream	Connection Stability	Clean stream with minimal jitter
Text-to-Speech Output	Subjective Quality	Clear & intelligible vocalization
End-to-End Translation	Response Time Latency	1.2–2.5 sec per continuous sequence

Table 5.1: Performance Evaluation of SignVision System

5.2 Comparison With Existing Systems

Feature	Mainstream Video Call (Zoom)	Human Interpreter Services	Standalone ASL Dictionary Apps	SignVision (Proposed)
Live Translation Support	None	Yes (Third-party)	Isolated / Static	Continuous & Live
Cost & Logistics Efficiency	High	Very Low	High	High
Privacy Preservation	High	Low (Monitored)	High	High (Client Computation)
Multi-Modal (STT/TTS)	STT Only	Native audio	None	Bi-Directional STT/TTS
Adaptive UI for Disabilities	Minimal	N/A	Minimal	Highly Adaptive Profiles
Smart IoT Control	None	None	None	Yes (Gesture Based)

Table 5.2: Comparison of Existing Systems with Proposed SignVision Platform

5.3 Overall Discussion

The SignVision system effectively demonstrates that a native bi-directional, AI-powered platform can successfully eliminate the communication gap between signers and non-signers in live conferencing environments. The powerful integration of spatial landmark abstraction (MediaPipe) and

sequential temporal inference (LSTM) ensures high accuracy over continuous sentences without sacrificing user privacy to cloud tracking.

While certain environmental limitations exist—such as susceptibility to extreme lighting factors and minor inference latencies on older hardware—the system proves to be a vastly superior, cost-effective alternative to relying on third-party human interpreters. Furthermore, the inclusion of Smart IoT controls and adaptive profiles solidifies the platform’s holistic approach to accessibility. Overall, the project successfully achieves its goal of providing an inclusive, robust, and socially empowering communication platform for users with compounding disabilities.

Chapter 6

Conclusion

The SignVision system successfully demonstrates the design and implementation of an inclusive, bi-directional communication platform capable of operating in real-time conversational environments. The project integrates multiple AI-driven modules such as spatial landmark extraction via MediaPipe, continuous sequence prediction using LSTM neural networks, Speech-to-Text (STT) captioning, Text-to-Speech (TTS) vocalization, and localized Smart IoT automation directly into a unified WebRTC video conferencing pipeline.

The system is able to simultaneously process complex American Sign Language (ASL) gestures and spoken audio, generating accurate, context-aware translations in both text and synthesized speech. The use of advanced temporal models ensures reliable performance and natural interaction speed, while the modular client-server architecture allows each component to function securely, minimizing video latency and protecting user privacy.

The system performs effectively in bridging the communication gap between signers and non-signers and demonstrates robustness in live video interactions. It comprehensively enhances accessibility for the Deaf, Hard of Hearing, and Speech-Impaired communities by providing adaptive disability profiles, multi-modal interfaces, and integrated gesture-based physical environment controls.

Overall, the project achieves its objective of developing an efficient, accessible, and intelligent bi-directional platform. It contributes to equal social and professional access, ultimately reducing the dependency on costly, intrusive third-party human interpreters in modern digital communications.

Chapter 7

Future Scope

Although the SignVision system demonstrates highly effective bi-directional continuous translation, there are several areas where the system can be further improved and extended for widespread real-world deployment.

- **Integration with Global IoT Ecosystems:** The current system demonstrates Smart IoT automation using specialized command structures. In the future, it can be integrated directly with mainstream smart home APIs (e.g., Apple HomeKit, Google Home, Amazon Alexa) to control a much wider array of commercial household appliances.
- **Reduction of AI Inference Latency:** The deep learning pipeline involves continuous frame extraction and temporal translation, which can introduce slight processing delays. Future work can focus on exploring lightweight Transformer models or utilizing WebAssembly (Wasm) for faster, hardware-accelerated edge processing to reduce response times further.
- **Improved Environmental Robustness:** While MediaPipe holistic tracking provides strong spatial data, it can be hindered by complex backgrounds or poor lighting. Advanced computer vision techniques and dynamic lighting compensation algorithms can be explored to ensure flawless tracking in uncontrolled, real-world environments.
- **Broader Vocabulary and Grammar Parsing:** Currently, the system accurately translates a defined corpus of continuous ASL and finger-spelling. This can be significantly improved by implementing large-scale Continuous Sign Language Recognition (CSLR) datasets to handle complex localized slang, varied sentence structures, and subtle grammatical facial expressions.
- **Support for Additional Sign Languages:** The system can be extended to include other international sign languages, such as Indian Sign Language (ISL) or British Sign Language (BSL), and translate them interchangeably into multiple spoken languages, making it globally inclusive.

- **User Personalization and Federated Learning:** The system can be enhanced to adapt dynamically to a user's unique signing speed, physical stature, and specific dialect preferences over time. Utilizing secure on-device learning can provide a personalized experience without compromising privacy.
- **AR/VR and Mobile Ecosystem Integration:** The platform can be evolved beyond web-based conferencing. Integrating the technology into mobile applications or Augmented Reality (AR) headsets (such as smart glasses) could overlay translated text directly into a user's field of view during in-person, face-to-face physical conversations.

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Chapter 8

PUBLICATIONS

8.1 PAPER STATUS

8.2 ACHIEVEMENTS

Chapter 9

IMPLEMENTATION

9.1 SCREENSHOTS

9.2 CODE SNIPPETS

Chapter 10

Alignment with Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)

SDG No.	Goal	Justification
3	Good Health and Well-Being	Supports the mental well-being of Deaf and Speech-Impaired communities by reducing social isolation, and ensures critical access to clear communication during medical telehealth consultations.
4	Quality Education	Promotes inclusive digital education by providing real-time ASL translation and live captioning, enabling students with disabilities to actively participate in virtual learning environments.
8	Decent Work and Economic Growth	Facilitates equal professional opportunities and remote work participation by bridging the communication gap within mainstream WebRTC business conferencing platforms.
9	Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure	Drives technological innovation by seamlessly integrating deep learning AI (LSTM, MediaPipe) with telecommunications and IoT systems to build cutting-edge assistive infrastructure.

10	Reduced Inequalities	Significantly dismantles systemic communication barriers and fosters equal social access for individuals with compounding disabilities through adaptive user profiles and bi-directional translation.
11	Sustainable Cities and Communities	Fosters inclusive, accessible, and independent living environments by integrating gesture-based Smart Home (IoT) automation tailored for individuals with physical or sensory disabilities.
17	Partnerships for the Goals	Demonstrates cross-domain technological integration by uniting advanced AI frameworks, web communication protocols, and hardware components to create comprehensive assistive ecosystems.

Table 10.1: Alignment of the SignVision Project with relevant United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)